Stockraft

AI MODEL · CLAUDE

MASTER PROMPTS PDF

Claude AI for Trading Strategy

The 3 Master Prompts

The exact, fully-detailed prompt templates I use to turn raw XAUUSD candle data into a tradable edge — using only Claude AI and free chart data.

No code. No subscriptions. No guessing.

📈 Swing Points | 🕯️ Candle Structure | 💧 Liquidity Sweeps

By **@stockraft** • XAUUSD Trading Education • 2026 Edition

INTRODUCTION

How to Use This Guide

This guide contains **three master prompts** — fully-engineered conversational templates that turn Claude AI into a research analyst for your trading data. Each prompt is designed to do something a human cannot: scan thousands of candles, extract repeatable patterns, and surface a **positive-expectancy edge** you can actually trade.

Unlike a one-off question, these are **iterative, conversational prompts**. Claude will ask you for context first — your data columns, your definitions, your timeframe preferences. That's the design. The more you tell it, the sharper its output.

> 💡 Each master prompt below is structured the same way: **(1) Context block** describing what you want, **(2) Clarifying questions** Claude asks back, **(3) Analysis instructions** for what to extract, and **(4) Output format** so you can act on the result.

STEP-BY-STEP WORKFLOW

- **Pick a timeframe and data range.** 6 months of 5M candles is the gold standard — enough history for statistical confidence without overwhelming Claude's context window.
- **Download a clean CSV** from TradingView (Replay → Export), MetaTrader 4/5 (History Center), Investing.com, or Dukascopy. Make sure columns are labeled — usually Date, Open, High, Low, Close, Volume.
- **Open a new Claude conversation** and upload the CSV. Wait for Claude to acknowledge it has the data.
- **Paste one master prompt at a time.** Don't run all three in the same conversation — context separation gives sharper outputs.
- **Answer Claude's clarifying questions honestly.** The more specific you are, the more relevant the patterns it surfaces.
- **Validate by hand.** Open your charting platform, check 10-20 of the cases Claude flagged. Does the pattern actually look like what Claude described? This step is non-negotiable.
- **Forward-test on demo for 2 weeks** before risking real capital. Past patterns hint at probabilities — they don't guarantee them.

> 🎯 These prompts are written for **XAUUSD (Gold)** on the 5M, 15M, 1H, and 4H timeframes — but they work for any liquid forex pair, index, or crypto with enough historical data.

DATA SETUP

Get Your Data — Free Sources

Before you can run any of these prompts, you need clean OHLC (Open-High-Low-Close) candle data in CSV format. Below are the five sources I recommend, ranked by ease and quality. **All are free.**

1. TRADINGVIEW PREMIUM

Open chart → click Replay icon → scroll back as far as needed → click Export → CSV. Best for clean data with all timeframes available.

2. METATRADER 4 / 5

Tools → History Center → select pair + timeframe → Export. Works offline, gives you tick-level data if you want it. Most accurate for forex.

3. INVESTING.COM

Free, no account required. Go to the asset's page → Historical Data tab → Download. Good for daily and weekly. Limited intraday range.

4. DUKASCOPY

Free historical tick data. Requires basic registration. Best granularity available without paying — useful for very precise sweep analysis.

5. YAHOO FINANCE

Daily candles only. Click Historical Data on any ticker page → Download. Use for swing-trading prompts on Daily timeframe; doesn't work for intraday.

CSV FORMAT CLAUDE EXPECTS

Your CSV should have columns roughly matching this format. Most platforms export this layout by default:

```
Date,Time,Open,High,Low,Close,Volume
2025-10-15,09:30,4485.20,4488.90,4483.10,4487.50,1842
2025-10-15,09:35,4487.50,4490.80,4486.40,4489.20,1567
2025-10-15,09:40,4489.20,4491.30,4488.10,4488.75,1923
...
```

⚠️ If your platform exports with timezone in the date column, mention it to Claude. Liquidity sweep and session analysis depend on accurate time data — IST conversion matters for Indian traders.

PRO TIPS FOR CLEANER DATA

- Strip **weekend candles** if your CSV includes them (forex doesn't trade Sat/Sun, but some exports include placeholder rows).
- Use **at least 6 months of data** for statistical confidence on swing/breakout prompts. 12 months is even better.
- For **5M timeframe**, 6 months = ~26,000 candles. Claude can handle this in one CSV upload.

- Always **label your columns** in the header row. Claude can infer them but explicit naming reduces errors.

MASTER PROMPT 1

Swing Points — Pattern Detector

This first prompt is the foundation. It teaches Claude to scan your CSV for every swing high and swing low across the entire dataset — then surface the **repeatable patterns** that occur around them. This is where 80% of your edge will come from.

WHAT THIS PROMPT WILL DISCOVER

- **Time clusters** — specific hours when swing highs/lows form most often (e.g. 'most highs form 13:30–14:30 IST')
- **Session bias** — which session (Asian / London / NY) produces the cleanest reversals
- **Sweep depth distribution** — typical pip distance price extends past the prior swing before reversing
- **Reversal candle patterns** — what type of candles tend to confirm the swing (engulfing? pin bar? doji?)
- **Holding period** — how many candles a swing high/low typically holds before being broken or violated

WHY IT WORKS

Most traders *think* they know when swings form — 'they happen at session opens' is the cliché answer. But your data may say something different. Maybe XAUUSD swing highs in your specific 6-month window cluster at **14:15–14:45 IST** (London open + 15 min buffer), not at exactly 13:30. That precision is the edge.

This prompt also asks Claude to differentiate between **major swings** (4H structure) and **minor swings** (1H/5M micro-structure). The patterns at each level are different — and most retail traders mix them up.

> 💡 Run this prompt on the highest timeframe relevant to your style. Day traders should use 1H or 4H. Scalpers can use 15M but should expect more noise. Below 5M, statistical patterns become unreliable due to spread and tick-level distortion.

PROMPT 1 · TEMPLATE

Copy. Paste. Run.

This is the full master prompt for swing-point pattern detection. Paste it into a fresh Claude conversation **after** uploading your CSV. Answer Claude's clarifying questions, then let it work.

📝 PASTE THIS INTO CLAUDE

```
ROLE: You are a quantitative trading research analyst.
I am giving you historical candle data in CSV format.

OBJECTIVE:
Identify all swing highs and swing lows in this dataset, then
surface the REPEATABLE PATTERNS that occur around them.

═══ STEP 1: ASK ME FIRST ═══
Before analyzing, ask me:
  1. What instrument and timeframe is this data?
  2. What's my swing definition? (e.g., 5-candle fractal, ZigZag
     0.5%, manual annotation)
  3. What sessions am I tracking? (default: Asian / London / NY
     in IST timezone)
  4. Should you split major vs minor swings? If yes, what's the
     threshold?
  5. Any specific date range to focus on or exclude?

Wait for my answers before proceeding. Do not assume.

═══ STEP 2: IDENTIFY ALL SWING POINTS ═══
Once I confirm the parameters:
  - Mark every swing high and swing low based on my definition
  - For each swing, extract:
    * Date and time (in IST)
    * Active session (Asian / London / NY / Off-hours)
    * Price level
    * Number of candles since the previous swing in same direction
    * Sweep distance: how many pips price extended past the prior
      same-direction swing before reversing
    * Reversal candle type (bullish/bearish engulfing, pin bar,
      doji, inside bar, none)
    * Holding period: how many candles before the swing was broken
      or invalidated

═══ STEP 3: FIND THE REPEATING PATTERNS ═══
Group and analyze the swings. Tell me:
  1. Time-of-day clustering — are swing highs concentrated in
     specific 30-min windows? Same for swing lows.
  2. Session bias — which session produces the most swings?
     The cleanest reversals?
  3. Sweep depth distribution — what's the median, average, and
     90th percentile sweep distance before reversal?
  4. Reversal candle bias — which candle pattern shows up most
```

```
     often at swing reversals?
  5. Day-of-week clustering — do certain days produce more swings
     or different swing behavior?

═══ STEP 4: OUTPUT FORMAT ═══
Give me:
  A. A summary table of the top 5 most repetitive patterns you
     found, ranked by frequency and statistical confidence
  B. For each pattern: sample size, win/repeat rate, edge
     description in plain English, and one example trade idea
  C. A "watchlist" of times/conditions to monitor going forward

═══ IMPORTANT RULES ═══
  - Do NOT give me your opinion or trading advice
  - Only report what the DATA shows — patterns with sample sizes
    of at least 30 instances
  - Flag any patterns that look statistically weak (n<30) clearly
  - If the data is incomplete or inconsistent, tell me what's
    missing before analyzing
  - Iterate with me — if I push back on a finding, refine the
    analysis with my new constraint
```

🛠️ If Claude gives a generic answer instead of asking clarifying questions, just reply: *'Please ask me the clarifying questions first before analysing.'* It will reset and follow the prompt structure correctly.

PROMPT 1 · EXAMPLE

What the Output Looks Like

Below is an illustrative example of what Claude returns after running Master Prompt 1 on a 6-month XAUUSD 1H dataset. Your numbers will differ based on your specific data.

CLAUDE'S CLARIFYING QUESTIONS (ANSWERS IN [BRACKETS])

→ Instrument and timeframe? [XAUUSD, 1H]
→ Swing definition? [5-candle fractal — high/low surrounded by 2 lower/higher highs on each side]
→ Sessions in IST? [Asian 5–13, London 13–18, NY 18–23, Off 23–5]
→ Major vs minor split? [Yes, major = move > 30 pips, minor = 10–30 pips]
→ Date range? [Last 6 months, full data]

CLAUDE'S TOP 5 REPETITIVE PATTERNS (ILLUSTRATIVE)

→ **Pattern 1:** 41% of major swing highs form within 90 min of London open (13:30–15:00 IST). Sample n=87, statistical confidence high.
→ **Pattern 2:** Average sweep depth before reversal = 18 pips. 90th percentile = 32 pips. Place SL at 35 pips for safety.
→ **Pattern 3:** Bullish engulfing candles confirm 64% of swing lows in NY session. Highest single-candle confirmation pattern.
→ **Pattern 4:** Asian session swings have 58% retracement rate within next 4 hours — typically not worth trading.
→ **Pattern 5:** Tuesday + Wednesday produce 53% of all major swings. Monday is often choppy; Friday is news-distorted.

HOW TO INTERPRET THESE FINDINGS

- **Pattern 1 → trading rule:** Set price alerts at 13:30 IST. Watch for swing highs forming over the next 90 minutes. This is your high-probability window.
- **Pattern 2 → SL sizing:** Use 25–35 pip stops on swing trades, not 10–15. The data says price routinely extends 18+ pips past the prior swing.
- **Pattern 3 → confirmation:** Wait for a bullish engulfing on the 5M chart at the 1H demand zone before entering long.
- **Pattern 5 → calendar planning:** Most aggressive on Tue/Wed, lighter on Mon/Fri. Save risk capital for the days the data favors you.

⚠️ These patterns are **illustrative** — your actual results will vary based on the period you analyse, the instrument, and your swing definition. **Always validate by hand** before risking capital.

MASTER PROMPT 2

Candle Structure — Breakout Edge

The second prompt finds **repetitive candlestick structures** — specifically, breakout candles that have positive expectancy at a 1:2 reward-to-risk. This is where short-term, mechanical edge lives.

WHAT THIS PROMPT WILL DISCOVER

- **Breakout follow-through rate** — how often a strong-body candle breaking the previous N high actually continues vs reverses
- **Body size threshold** — at what % body size (60%? 70%?) does the breakout become statistically reliable
- **Session edge** — which sessions produce the cleanest breakout continuations vs the most fakeouts
- **Wick-to-body ratio** — how much wick is acceptable before the breakout signal becomes unreliable
- **Volume confirmation** — if your data has volume, does volume on the breakout candle predict follow-through
- **Optimal R:R** — what's the average follow-through in pips, and at what target level does win rate × R:R produce the best expected value

WHY THIS MATTERS

Every retail trader has heard 'trade the breakout.' Most don't realize **most breakouts fail**. The real edge isn't 'breakouts work' — it's knowing *which* breakouts work, *when*, and *under what conditions*. That's what this prompt extracts from your data.

The prompt is designed to test the breakout idea against a strict **1:2 R:R with positive expectancy** filter. If a breakout pattern wins 50% but only by 0.5R, it has zero expectancy. Claude filters these out and only shows you setups where **(win rate × avg win) > (loss rate × avg loss)**.

> 💡 This prompt works best on **5M, 15M, and 1H** timeframes. Below 5M, breakouts are too noisy. Above 1H, you don't get enough samples in 6 months for statistical confidence.

PROMPT 2 · TEMPLATE

Copy. Paste. Run.

This master prompt finds breakout candles in your data and tests them against a strict 1:2 R:R + positive expectancy filter. **Most breakouts will fail this test — and that's the point.** Only the ones that pass are worth trading.

📝 PASTE THIS INTO CLAUDE

```
ROLE: You are a quantitative trading research analyst.
I am giving you candle data in CSV format. Your job is to find
repetitive CANDLESTICK BREAKOUT patterns that have positive
expectancy at 1:2 R:R.

═══ STEP 1: ASK ME FIRST ═══
Before analyzing, ask me:
  1. What instrument and timeframe is this data?
  2. What does "breakout" mean to me? Options:
     a) Close above prev N candles' high (specify N)
     b) High above prev N candles' high (intra-candle break)
     c) Close above a specific level I'll provide
  3. What's my body-size threshold? (default: body > 60% of
     total candle range)
  4. Should I include or exclude breakouts that occur during
     news events?
  5. What R:R do you want me to test? (default: 1:2)
  6. What's my SL placement? Below the breakout candle's low?
     Below recent swing low? Fixed pips?

Wait for my answers. Do not assume.

═══ STEP 2: IDENTIFY ALL BREAKOUT CANDLES ═══
Find every candle that meets the breakout definition. For each,
extract:
  - Date, time (IST), session
  - Body size (close - open) as % of total range (high - low)
  - Number of candles broken
  - Close position within the candle (upper third / middle /
    lower third)
  - Volume (if available)
  - Wick-to-body ratio on the upper wick (for bullish breaks)
  - Next 5 candles' direction and total move in pips
  - Whether the trade hit 1R, 2R, 3R, or stopped out at -1R
    (using my SL placement rule)

═══ STEP 3: ANALYSIS — POSITIVE EXPECTANCY FILTER ═══
For the full set of breakouts:
  1. Win rate at 1:2 R:R
  2. Average winner (in R) and average loser (in R)
  3. Expectancy formula: (win% × avg_win_R) - (loss% × avg_loss_R)
  4. Only flag patterns with expectancy > 0.2R per trade
```

```
Then segment the breakouts by:
  - Body size buckets (60-70%, 70-80%, 80-90%, 90-100%)
  - Session (Asian / London / NY)
  - Day of week
  - Volume quartile (if available)
  - Wick ratio

For each segment, recompute win rate and expectancy. Tell me
WHICH segment has the highest expectancy.

═══ STEP 4: OUTPUT FORMAT ═══
Give me:
  A. Overall stats: total breakouts found, baseline win rate at
     1:2, baseline expectancy
  B. The top 3 breakout SEGMENTS with the highest positive
     expectancy, including sample size, win rate, expected value
     per trade in R
  C. Negative segments — combinations to AVOID (negative expectancy)
  D. A clear "rule of thumb" entry checklist I can apply going
     forward

═══ IMPORTANT RULES ═══
  - Sample size minimum 30 per segment for any conclusion
  - Do NOT report win rate without expectancy — they're meaningless
    alone
  - Flag any survivorship bias or look-ahead bias in your method
  - If the data quality is weak, say so before analyzing
  - Iterate — if a segment looks promising, drill deeper when I ask
```

🛠️ If Claude returns just a win rate without expectancy, ask: *'Recalculate using expectancy formula — (win% × avg_win_R) - (loss% × avg_loss_R) — and only flag segments with expectancy > 0.2R.'*

MASTER PROMPT 3

Liquidity Sweeps — HTF Edge

The third prompt finds **liquidity sweeps** — instances where price extends past a higher-timeframe key level (4H low, Daily high, prev session high/low) and then reverses sharply. This is the SMC / institutional concept that drives most professional setups.

WHAT THIS PROMPT WILL DISCOVER

- **Sweep frequency** — how often does price actually sweep an HTF level vs respect it cleanly
- **Sweep depth** — how many pips below/above the level price typically extends before reversing
- **Reversal speed** — within how many candles does the sweep reverse (1? 3? 8?)
- **HTF level type bias** — do 4H lows sweep more than Daily lows? Asian highs vs NY highs?
- **Time-of-day bias** — when do sweeps occur most? London open is the prime suspect, but the data may surprise you
- **Sweep vs continuation** — when sweeps fail to reverse (continuation pattern), what's the early warning signal
- **Optimal entry timing** — should you enter on the wick rejection, the engulfing close, or the next-candle confirmation

WHY THIS PROMPT IS DIFFERENT

Sweeps are higher-timeframe events that play out on lower-timeframe candles. This prompt requires Claude to **combine multiple timeframes** — usually 4H levels and 5M execution data. The prompt explicitly asks Claude to clarify which HTF you want analysed, and what data it needs from you to do the cross-timeframe analysis.

This is the most data-hungry of the three prompts. You'll need **5M or 15M data plus a list of HTF levels** (or a separate HTF CSV that Claude can derive levels from). Don't skip the data preparation — Claude can't conjure HTF levels out of nothing.

> 💡 If you only have 5M data, ask Claude to **derive HTF levels from the 5M data** first (resample to 4H), then run the sweep analysis on the 5M. It's an extra step but works fine.

PROMPT 3 · TEMPLATE

Copy. Paste. Run.

This is the most powerful and most data-hungry of the three master prompts. It needs HTF levels — either provided by you separately, or derived by Claude from your data. Once it has them, it surfaces real institutional-style edges.

📝 PASTE THIS INTO CLAUDE

```
ROLE: You are a quantitative trading research analyst.
I want to find liquidity sweeps of higher-timeframe levels in
this candle data, and identify which sweeps offer positive
expectancy.

══ STEP 1: ASK ME FIRST ══
Before analyzing, you MUST ask:
  1. What instrument and timeframe is the data I uploaded?
  2. Which HTF (higher timeframe) levels do I want analysed?
     a) 4H swing lows
     b) 4H swing highs
     c) Daily highs/lows
     d) Previous session high/low (Asian/London/NY)
     e) Weekly highs/lows
     f) All of the above
  3. Do I have HTF levels listed separately, or should you
     derive them by resampling my data?
  4. Minimum sweep depth threshold (default: ≥10 pips beyond
     the level)
  5. Maximum candles to "close back above/below" before the
     sweep is invalid (default: 3 candles)
  6. Where does my SL go? Below the sweep wick? Fixed pips?
  7. Where's my TP? Previous HTF level? Fixed R:R?

Do NOT assume. Wait for my answers.

══ STEP 2: IDENTIFY ALL SWEEP EVENTS ══
For each HTF level I specified:
  - Mark the level on my data (you may need to derive HTF candles
    first)
  - Find every instance where my lower-timeframe candle wicked
    BEYOND the level by at least my minimum threshold
  - Check if the next 1-N candles closed back inside the level
    (passing my "close back" criterion)
  - This is a SWEEP. Record it.

For each sweep, extract:
  - Date, time, IST session
  - Which HTF level was swept
  - Sweep depth (pips beyond the level)
  - Number of candles to close back inside
  - Wick-to-body ratio of the sweep candle
  - Next 1-10 candle action: did price reverse? How far?
```

```
  - Did price hit the previous opposite HTF level? (= maximum
    target)
  - If trading the sweep: did it hit 1R, 2R, 3R, or stop out?

═══ STEP 3: ANALYSIS — EDGE EXTRACTION ═══
Compute and segment:
  1. Sweep success rate by HTF level type (4H low vs Daily high vs
     Asian high…)
  2. Sweep success rate by session
  3. Sweep success rate by sweep depth bucket (10-15 pips, 15-25,
     25-40, 40+)
  4. Sweep success rate by time-to-reverse (1 candle, 2 candles,
     3 candles)
  5. Expectancy at 1:2 R:R for each segment
  6. Maximum drawdown if I traded every sweep — risk-of-ruin check

═══ STEP 4: OUTPUT FORMAT ═══
Give me:
  A. Overall stats: total sweeps found, baseline win rate,
     baseline expectancy
  B. Top 3 highest-expectancy SWEEP TYPES (with sample sizes +
     specific entry rules)
  C. Sweeps to AVOID (negative expectancy combinations)
  D. A complete trading rule:
     IF [HTF level type X] is swept by [Y pips] in [Z session]
     AND closes back within [N candles]
     THEN enter [direction] with SL at [location] and TP at
     [location]
  E. Risk warnings: max consecutive losses, biggest drawdown
     scenario

═══ IMPORTANT RULES ═══
  - Sample size minimum 30 per segment
  - Distinguish CLEARLY between "sweeps that reverse" (tradable
    edge) and "fake sweeps that continue" (catastrophic if traded)
  - Calculate expectancy in R units, not in dollars or pips
  - Flag any pattern that depends on a single outlier event
  - Iterate with me — let me drill into any segment that looks
    interesting
```

🛠️ If you only have 5M data and Claude struggles, paste this follow-up: *'Resample my 5M data to 4H first. Identify the 4H swing highs and lows. Then use those as the HTF levels for the sweep analysis on the 5M data.'*

VALIDATE BY HAND

Trust, But Verify

AI surfaces candidate patterns. **You confirm them by hand.** This step is non-negotiable. Skipping it is the single biggest reason traders blow up accounts trying to trade AI-generated 'edges.'

THE 6-STEP MANUAL VALIDATION PROCESS

- **Open your charting platform** (TradingView, MT5, etc.) and pull up the same instrument and timeframe Claude analysed.
- **Take Claude's top finding** — the one with the highest expectancy and largest sample size — and write it down as a rule.
- **Pick 10–20 historical instances** at random from Claude's flagged times. Use TradingView's Replay mode to step through them.
- **Visually confirm each one.** Did the pattern actually look like what Claude described? If 8/10 do, the pattern is real. If 4/10 do, Claude's pattern definition is fuzzy and needs refinement.
- **Note the edge cases.** What about the 2/10 that don't fit? Are they failures, or is your rule too narrow?
- **Forward-test on demo for 2 weeks minimum.** Trade the rule live on demo, not historical. If it holds up under live conditions, then — and only then — risk real capital.

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

❌ TRUSTING AI BLINDLY

Claude can hallucinate patterns. It can also misinterpret your data. Always cross-check 10–20 cases manually before believing anything.

❌ INSUFFICIENT SAMPLE SIZE

Patterns with n<30 are statistical noise. Claude should flag these — but if it doesn't, you should ignore them.

❌ IGNORING EXPECTANCY

A 70% win rate at 1:0.5 R:R is a losing strategy. Always look at expectancy in R, not raw win rate.

❌ CURVE-FITTING ON SMALL DATA

Patterns that look great on 1 month of data often fail on 6 months. Always use 6+ months for prompt 1 & 2, 12+ months for prompt 3.

> 🎯 AI is a research partner, not an oracle. Treat its output the way a junior analyst presents findings to a senior PM — interesting, but always verified before acting.

QUICK REFERENCE

Your 8-Step **Workflow**

01
PICK DATA
Choose timeframe + 6mo data range.

02
DOWNLOAD CSV
From TradingView, MT5, or Investing.com.

03
UPLOAD TO CLAUDE
New conversation, attach CSV.

04
RUN PROMPT 1
Swing point pattern detection.

05
RUN PROMPT 2
Candle structure breakouts.

06
RUN PROMPT 3
Liquidity sweeps of HTF levels.

07 ⭐
VALIDATE BY HAND
10–20 manual cases. Non-negotiable.

08
FORWARD-TEST
2 weeks demo before real capital.

THE EDGE EQUATION

🤖 AI FINDS + 👁️ YOU VALIDATE = 🏆 REAL EDGE

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